

TatvaCare

Indian Primary Care Drug Formulary

93 essential drugs · Class · Indications · Dose · Side effects · Interactions · Schedule

Sources: CDSCO NLEM 2022 · WHO EML 2023 · Current Indian prescribing patterns

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Drug categories covered:

Aminopenicillin antibiotic · β -lactamase inhibitor · Macrolide antibiotic · Fluoroquinolone antibiotic · Tetracycline antibiotic · 3rd-gen cephalosporin · Nitroimidazole antimicrobial · Triazole antifungal · Antiviral (guanosine analogue) · Neuraminidase inhibitor · Non-opioid analgesic / antipyretic · NSAID (propionic acid) · NSAID (arylacetic acid) · NSAID (propionic acid, long-acting) · Antiplatelet / NSAID · Atypical opioid analgesic · 5-HT₃ antagonist (antiemetic) · Glucose solution · Osmotic laxative (synthetic disaccharide) · Calcium channel blocker (dihydropyridine) · Angiotensin II receptor blocker (ARB) · ACE inhibitor · Thiazide diuretic · Thiazide-like diuretic (long-acting) · Loop diuretic · Potassium-sparing diuretic (aldosterone antagonist) · HMG-CoA reductase inhibitor (statin) · Statin (more potent, less CYP metabolism) · P2Y₁₂ receptor antagonist (antiplatelet) · Vitamin K antagonist (oral anticoagulant) · Cardiac glycoside (positive inotrope) · Organic nitrate (vasodilator) · Organic nitrate (rapid-acting) · Non-selective β -blocker · Biguanide (insulin sensitizer) · Sulfonylurea (insulin secretagogue) · Sulfonylurea (short-acting) · DPP-4 inhibitor (gliptin) · SGLT2 inhibitor (gliflozin) · Thyroid hormone (T₄) · Short-acting β -blocker · Histamine H₁ receptor antagonist · 2nd-gen H₁ antihistamine · 2nd-gen H₁ antihistamine (active enantiomer) · 2nd-gen H₁ antihistamine (non-sedating) · Mucolytic (ambroxol) · Antitussive (NMDA antagonist, α - γ -butyrolactone) · SSRI antidepressant · SSRI · Short-acting benzodiazepine · Long-acting benzodiazepine · Tricyclic antidepressant (TCA) · Sodium channel blocker (anticonvulsant) · Anticonvulsant (multi-mechanism) · Anticonvulsant (SV2A modulator) · Antimetabolite / DMARD · DMARD / antimalarial · Xanthine oxidase inhibitor · Xanthine oxidase inhibitor (non-purine) · Parenteral iron · Oral iron supplement · B vitamin (folate) · Vitamin B12 · Vitamin D supplement · Calcium supplement · Short-acting antimuscarinic (SAMA) · Long-acting antimuscarinic (LAMA) · Combination antitussive + decongestant + antihistamine · Combination antimicrobial kit · 5-nitroimidazole (antiprotozoal) · Anthelmintic (benzimidazole) · Antiparasitic (ivermectin) · Synthetic glucocorticoid · Tetracycline antibiotic + probiotic · Imidazole antifungal (topical) · Topical antibiotic (pseudomonic acid A) · Topical antiseptic · Fluoroquinolone + steroid (topical) · Hormone (antidiabetic) · Selective estrogen receptor modulator (SERM)

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Acyclovir	Antiviral (guanosine analogue)	Albendazole	Anthelmintic (benzimidazole)
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Ambroxol	Mucolytic (ambroxol)	Amitriptyline	Tricyclic antidepressant (TCA)
Amlodipine	Calcium channel blocker (dihydropyridine)	Amoxicillin	Aminopenicillin antibiotic
Amoxicillin + Clavulanic acid	β-Lactamase inhibitor	Aspirin (low dose)	Antiplatelet / NSAID
Atenolol	β ₁ -adrenoceptor blocker	Atorvastatin	HMG-CoA reductase inhibitor (statin)
Azithromycin	Macrolide antibiotic	Azithromycin + Fluconazole + Secnidazole (combination kit)	Antifungal kit
Betadine (Povidone-iodine)	Topical antiseptic	Budesonide + Formoterol	ICS + LABA combination
Calcium carbonate	Calcium supplement	Carbamazepine	Sodium channel blocker (anticonvulsant)
Cefixime	3rd-gen cephalosporin	Cetirizine	2nd-gen H1 antihistamine
Chlorthalidone	Thiazide-like diuretic (long-acting)	Ciplox-D (Ciprofloxacin + Dexamethasone, ear/eye drops)	Combination (topical)
Ciprofloxacin	Fluoroquinolone antibiotic	Clonazepam	Long-acting benzodiazepine
Clopidogrel	P2Y ₁₂ receptor antagonist (antiplatelet)	Clotrimazole (topical)	Imidazole antifungal (topical)
Cough syrup (dextromethorphan + phenylephrine + CEM) + decongestant + antihistamine	Antitussive (NMDA antagonist) + α ₁ -adrenoceptor blocker + antihistamine	Cyanocobalamin (B12)	Vitamin B12
Digoxin	Cardiac glycoside (positive inotrope)	Diclofenac	NSAID (arylacetic acid)
Doxycycline	Tetracycline antibiotic	Domperidone	Peripheral D2 antagonist (prokinetic)
Empagliflozin	SGLT2 inhibitor (gliflozin)	Doxycycline + Lactobacillus	Tetracycline antibiotic + probiotic
Escitalopram	SSRI	Enalapril	ACE inhibitor
Febuxostat	Xanthine oxidase inhibitor (non-purine)	Famotidine	H2 receptor antagonist
Fexofenadine	2nd-gen H1 antihistamine (non-sedating)	Ferrous sulfate (oral)	Oral iron supplement
Folic acid	B vitamin (folate)	Fluconazole	Triazole antifungal
Glimepiride	Sulfonylurea (insulin secretagogue)	Furosemide	Loop diuretic
Glyceryl Trinitrate (GTN, sublingual)	Organic nitrate (rapid-acting)	Glipizide	Sulfonylurea (short-acting)
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Hydroxychloroquine (SLE)	DMARD / antimalarial	Hydrochlorothiazide	Thiazide diuretic
Insulin (regular, NPH, glargine, aspart)	Insulin hormone (antidiabetic)	Ibuprofen	NSAID (propionic acid)
Iron sucrose (IV)	Parenteral iron	Ipratropium bromide	Short-acting antimuscarinic (SAMA)
Ivermectin	Antiparasitic (avermectin)	Isosorbide Mononitrate	Organic nitrate (vasodilator)
Levetiracetam	Anticonvulsant (SV2A modulator)	Lactulose	Osmotic laxative
Levothyroxine	Thyroid hormone (T4)	Levocetirizine	2nd-gen H1 antihistamine (active enantiomer)
Losartan	ARB	Loperamide	Antidiarrhoeal (gut sensitizer)
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Metronidazole	Nitroimidazole antimicrobial	Metoprolol	β ₁ -adrenoceptor blocker
Mupirocin	Topical antibiotic (pseudomonas acid A)	Montelukast	Leukotriene receptor antagonist
Omeprazole	Proton pump inhibitor (PPI)	Naproxen	NSAID (propionic acid, long-acting)
Oral Rehydration Salts (ORS)	Electrolyte/glucose solution	Ondansetron	5-HT ₃ antagonist (antiemetic)
Pantoprazole	PPI	Oseltamivir	Neuraminidase inhibitor
Phenytoin	Sodium channel blocker (anticonvulsant)	Paracetamol (Acetaminophen)	Non-opioid analgesic / antipyretic
Propranolol	Non-selective β ₁ blocker	Prednisolone	Synthetic glucocorticoid
Rosuvastatin	Statin (more potent, less CYP metabolism)	Ranitidine (withdrawn in many countries)	H ₂ receptor antagonist
Secnidazole	5-nitroimidazole (antiprotozoal)	Salbutamol (Albuterol)	Short-acting β ₂ -adrenoceptor agonist (SABA)
Sitagliptin	DPP-4 inhibitor (gliptin)	Sertraline	SSRI antidepressant
Tamoxifen	Selective estrogen receptor modulator (SERM)	Spirolactone	Potassium-sparing diuretic (aldosterone antagonist)
Tiotropium	Long-acting (SAMA)	Telmisartan	Angiotensin II receptor antagonist (ARB)
Valproate	Anticonvulsant (multi-mechanism)	Tramadol	Atypical opioid analgesic (μ-opioid agonist + SNRI)
Warfarin	Vitamin K antagonist (oral anticoagulant)	Vitamin D3 (Cholecalciferol)	Vitamin D supplement

Acyclovir

Acivir, Zovirax, Herpex

Antiviral (guanosine analogue)

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category B)

INDICATIONS

- B00.9** Herpes simplex
- B02.9** Herpes zoster (shingles)
- B00.1** Herpes labialis

ADULT DOSE

200-400 mg 5x/day × 5-7 days (herpes); 800 mg 5x/day × 7 days (zoster)

MECHANISM

Inhibits viral DNA polymerase after phosphorylation by viral thymidine kinase

SIDE EFFECTS

Nephrotoxicity (IV, especially with rapid infusion), nausea, headache

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Severe renal impairment (dose adjust)

PREGNANCY

safe (category B)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Probenecid, nephrotoxic drugs (aminoglycosides, NSAIDs)

ALSO KNOWN AS

aciclovir · zovirax · antiviral

Albendazole

Albenza, Almex, Bandy

Anthelmintic (benzimidazole)

Schedule OTC OTC Pregnancy: CONTRAINDICATED (category X)

INDICATIONS

- B77.9** Ascariasis (roundworm)
- B76.9** Hookworm
- B79** Trichuriasis (whipworm)
- B68.9** Taeniasis (tapeworm)

ADULT DOSE

400 mg single dose (most helminths); 400 mg BD × 7-14 days (hydatid, neurocysticercosis)

MECHANISM

Inhibits tubulin polymerization in helminths; depletes glucose uptake

SIDE EFFECTS

GI upset, hepatotoxicity, leukopenia, alopecia (high dose)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Pregnancy (teratogenic), breastfeeding, ocular cysticercosis

PREGNANCY

CONTRAINDICATED (category X)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Dexamethasone, praziquantel (increase albendazole levels), cimetidine

ALSO KNOWN AS

albendazole · almex · bandy · deworming · worm medicine

Allopurinol

Zyloric, Allopurinol, Allgoric

Xanthine oxidase inhibitor

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category C)

INDICATIONS

- M10.9** Chronic gout
- M10.0** Acute gout (NOT for acute; start after flare)
- N20.0** Uric acid kidney stones

ADULT DOSE

100-900 mg OD (start low, titrate to serum uric acid <6 mg/dL)

MECHANISM

Inhibits xanthine oxidase, reducing uric acid production

SIDE EFFECTS

Acute gout flare (on initiation — give prophylaxis), severe rash (SJS), hepatotoxicity

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Asymptomatic hyperuricemia, acute gout attack (without prophylaxis)

PREGNANCY

safe (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Azathioprine (severe toxicity), mercaptopurine, warfarin, ampicillin (rash)

ALSO KNOWN AS

zyloric · allopurinol · gout medicine · uric acid medicine

Alprazolam

Alprax, Xanax, Alprazolam

Short-acting benzodiazepine

Schedule H1 Rx required Pregnancy: CONTRAINDICATED (category D; cleft palate, floppy baby)

INDICATIONS

- F41.1 Anxiety (acute)
- F40.0 Panic disorder

ADULT DOSE

0.25-1 mg TDS PRN (max 4 mg/day)

MECHANISM

Potentiates GABA-A receptor activity (allosteric, increases Cl- conductance)

SIDE EFFECTS

Drowsiness, confusion, ataxia, dependence, withdrawal seizures

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Severe respiratory disease, sleep apnea, myasthenia gravis, narrow-angle glaucoma

PREGNANCY

CONTRAINDICATED (category D; cleft palate, floppy baby)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Alcohol, opioids (respiratory depression), CYP3A4 inhibitors

ALSO KNOWN AS

alprax · xanax · benzodiazepine · anxiety medicine · sedative

Ambroxol

Mucolite, Ambrodil, Mucosol

Mucolytic (*ambroxol*)

Schedule OTC **OTC** Pregnancy: avoid 1st trimester (category C)

INDICATIONS

- R05** Productive cough
- J18.9** Pneumonia (adjunct)

ADULT DOSE

30 mg TDS (oral); 75 mg SR BD

MECHANISM

Breaks down mucopolysaccharide fibers, stimulates surfactant production

SIDE EFFECTS

GI upset, headache, rare allergic reactions

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hypersensitivity

PREGNANCY

avoid 1st trimester (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

None significant

ALSO KNOWN AS

mucolite · ambrodil · mucolytic · cough medicine

Amitriptyline

Tryptomer, Amitone, Elavil

Tricyclic antidepressant (TCA)

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: avoid (category C)

INDICATIONS

- F32.9** Depression
- G43.9** Migraine prophylaxis
- G62.9** Neuropathic pain
- F51.0** Insomnia

ADULT DOSE

25-150 mg HS (depression); 10-25 mg HS (neuropathic pain/migraine prophylaxis)

MECHANISM

Inhibits reuptake of serotonin and norepinephrine; also has anticholinergic, antihistaminic, anti-; Vffects

SIDE EFFECTS
Dry mouth, constipation, urinary retention, blurred vision, orthostatic hypotension, weight gain, sedation, QT prolongation

CONTRAINDICATIONS
Recent MI, severe cardiac arrhythmia, narrow-angle glaucoma, MAOI use

PREGNANCY
avoid (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS
MAOIs, anticholinergics, opioids, alcohol, CYP2D6 inhibitors

ALSO KNOWN AS
tryptomer · amitriptyline · TCA · antidepressant · neuropathic pain medicine

Amlodipine

Amlogard, Amlong, Stamlo

Calcium channel blocker (dihydropyridine)

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category C; preferred in pregnancy HTN)

INDICATIONS

- I10** Essential hypertension
- I20.9** Angina (chronic stable)
- I50.9** Heart failure (rare)

ADULT DOSE

5-10 mg OD

MECHANISM

Blocks L-type calcium channels in vascular smooth muscle !' vasodilation

SIDE EFFECTS

Peripheral edema, headache, flushing, dizziness, gingival hyperplasia

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Severe aortic stenosis, cardiogenic shock

PREGNANCY

safe (category C; preferred in pregnancy HTN)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Simvastatin (max 20 mg with amlodipine), grapefruit juice, CYP3A4 inhibitors

ALSO KNOWN AS

amlogard · amlong · stamlo · BP medicine · calcium channel blocker

Amoxicillin

Mox, Amoxil, Novamox

Aminopenicillin antibiotic

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category B)

INDICATIONS

- J00** Acute URI
- J18.9** Pneumonia
- H66.9** Otitis media
- N39.0** UTI
- K02.1** Dental abscess

ADULT DOSE

250-500 mg TDS × 5-7 days

MECHANISM

Inhibits bacterial cell wall synthesis by binding penicillin-binding proteins

SIDE EFFECTS

Rash, diarrhea, nausea, GI upset; anaphylaxis in penicillin-allergic patients

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Penicillin allergy, infectious mononucleosis

PREGNANCY

safe (category B)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Methotrexate, oral contraceptives (reduced efficacy), probenecid, warfarin

ALSO KNOWN AS

amox · amoxy · broad spectrum penicillin

Amoxicillin + Clavulanic acid

Augmentin, Clavam, Moxikind-CV

β-lactamase inhibitor

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category B)

INDICATIONS

- J18.9** Pneumonia
- J06.9** Sinusitis
- L08.9** Skin/soft-tissue infection
- K81.9** Cholecystitis
- H66.9** Otitis media

ADULT DOSE

500/125 mg TDS or 875/125 mg BD × 5-7 days

MECHANISM

Clavulanic acid inhibits β-lactamase, restoring amoxicillin activity against resistant strains

SIDE EFFECTS

Diarrhea (very common), nausea, rash, candida overgrowth

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Penicillin allergy, cholestatic jaundice history

PREGNANCY

safe (category B)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Methotrexate, warfarin, OCP

ALSO KNOWN AS

augmentin · co-amoxiclav · amoxiclav

Aspirin (low dose)

Disprin, Ecosprin, Asacard

Antiplatelet / NSAID

Schedule OTC OTC Pregnancy: avoid 3rd trimester (category D)

INDICATIONS

- I20.9 Angina
- I63.9 Stroke (secondary prevention)
- I21.9 Post-MI
- R51 Headache (high dose)

ADULT DOSE

75-150 mg OD (antiplatelet); 300-600 mg q4-6h (analgesic)

MECHANISM

Irreversibly inhibits COX-1 in platelets; antiplatelet effect at low dose

SIDE EFFECTS

GI upset/ulcer, bleeding, tinnitus (toxicity), Reye syndrome in children

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Active bleed, peptic ulcer, children < 16 (viral infection — Reye), severe asthma

PREGNANCY

avoid 3rd trimester (category D)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Warfarin, ibuprofen (antagonizes), ACEi, methotrexate

ALSO KNOWN AS

ecosprin · disprin · low-dose aspirin · antiplatelet

Atenolol

Aten, Tenormin, Atenol

β₁-adrenergic receptor blocker

Schedule H **Rx required** **Pregnancy: safe (category D; used in pregnancy HTN)**

INDICATIONS

- I10** Hypertension
- I20.9** Angina
- I48.9** Atrial fibrillation (rate control)
- R00.0** Sinus tachycardia

ADULT DOSE

25-100 mg OD

MECHANISM

Competitive β₁ receptor antagonist

SIDE EFFECTS

Bradycardia, fatigue, cold extremities, bronchospasm (high dose), nightmares

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Severe bradycardia, heart block, severe asthma, decompensated heart failure

PREGNANCY

safe (category D; used in pregnancy HTN)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Verapamil/diltiazem (heart block), clonidine (rebound HTN), insulin (mask hypoglycemia)

ALSO KNOWN AS

aten · tenormin · beta blocker · BP medicine

Atorvastatin

Atorva, Storvas, Lipitor

HMG-CoA reductase inhibitor (statin)

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: CONTRAINDICATED (category X)

INDICATIONS

- E78.5 Hypercholesterolemia
- I21.9 Post-MI (secondary prevention)
- I63.9 Post-stroke (secondary prevention)

ADULT DOSE

10-80 mg HS

MECHANISM

Inhibits HMG-CoA reductase, reducing cholesterol synthesis in liver

SIDE EFFECTS

Myalgia, rhabdomyolysis (rare), elevated LFTs, GI upset

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Active liver disease, pregnancy, breastfeeding

PREGNANCY

CONTRAINDICATED (category X)

KEY INTERACTIONS

CYP3A4 inhibitors (clarithromycin, itraconazole, grapefruit), gemfibrozil, cyclosporine

ALSO KNOWN AS

atorva · storvas · lipitor · statin · cholesterol medicine

Azithromycin

Azithral, Zithromax, Azee

Macrolide antibiotic

Schedule H **Rx required** **Pregnancy: safe (category B)**

INDICATIONS

J18.9	Atypical pneumonia
J06.9	Sinusitis
A09.0	Traveller's diarrhea
H66.9	Otitis media
A55	Chlamydia

ADULT DOSE

500 mg OD × 3 days OR 1 g single dose (STI)

MECHANISM

Binds 50S ribosomal subunit, inhibits bacterial protein synthesis

SIDE EFFECTS

Nausea, abdominal pain, QT prolongation (rare), hepatotoxicity

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Macrolide allergy, severe hepatic disease, known QT prolongation

PREGNANCY

safe (category B)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Antacids reduce absorption, warfarin, digoxin, ergot alkaloids, statins (esp. simvastatin)

ALSO KNOWN AS

azee · z-pack · Z · macrolide

Azithromycin + Fluconazole + Secnidazole (combination kit)

Azee-Azee, Cz-3, Combo kits

Combination antimicrobial kit

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: avoid (category C; especially secnidazole)

INDICATIONS

- A59.0** Trichomoniasis + candidiasis combo
- N76.0** Mixed vaginal infection

ADULT DOSE

Azithromycin 1g + Fluconazole 150mg + Secnidazole 2g single dose (varies by kit)

MECHANISM

Combination antibacterial + antifungal + antiprotozoal

SIDE EFFECTS

Nausea, metallic taste, hepatotoxicity (rare)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hypersensitivity, severe hepatic disease, pregnancy 1st trimester

PREGNANCY

avoid (category C; especially secnidazole)

KEY INTERACTIONS

See individual drugs

ALSO KNOWN AS

combo kit · cz3 · trichomoniasis kit · vaginal kit

Betadine (Povidone-iodine)

Betadine, Povidone, Cipladine

Topical antiseptic

Schedule OTC OTC Pregnancy: safe (small areas); avoid extensive use

INDICATIONS

- T14.1** Wound antisepsis
- L08.9** Skin infection (adjunct)

ADULT DOSE

Apply 1-2x daily to wound area

MECHANISM

Releases iodine, oxidizes microbial proteins/nucleic acids

SIDE EFFECTS

Local irritation, allergic reaction, thyroid dysfunction (extensive use)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Iodine allergy, thyroid disease, pregnancy (extensive use), infants

PREGNANCY

safe (small areas); avoid extensive use

KEY INTERACTIONS

None significant (topical)

ALSO KNOWN AS

betadine · povidone iodine · antiseptic · wound wash

Budesonide + Formoterol

Foracort, Symbicort, Budamate

ICS + LABA combination

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: safe (category C; budesonide preferred in pregnancy)

INDICATIONS

- J45.9 Asthma (maintenance)
- J44.9 COPD (maintenance)

ADULT DOSE

200/6 mcg 1-2 puffs BD (maintenance)

MECHANISM

Budesonide = inhaled corticosteroid (anti-inflammatory); formoterol = long-acting β_2 agonist

SIDE EFFECTS

Oral thrush, hoarseness, dysphonia; tremor, tachycardia (formoterol)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Acute asthma exacerbation (rescue), severe hypersensitivity

PREGNANCY

safe (category C; budesonide preferred in pregnancy)

KEY INTERACTIONS

β -blockers, ketoconazole, ritonavir

ALSO KNOWN AS

foracort · symbicort · inhaler · asthma medicine · controller

Calcium carbonate

Shelcal, CCM, CCM With Vitamin D3

Calcium supplement

Schedule **OTC** **OTC** Pregnancy: **safe**

INDICATIONS

- E58 Calcium deficiency
- M81.0 Osteoporosis (with vitamin D)

ADULT DOSE

500-1000 mg elemental Ca/day

MECHANISM

Provides elemental calcium for bone and cellular function

SIDE EFFECTS

Constipation, hypercalcemia, kidney stones

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hypercalcemia, calcium kidney stones (relative)

PREGNANCY

safe

KEY INTERACTIONS

Tetracyclines, quinolones, iron, levothyroxine (reduce absorption)

ALSO KNOWN AS

shelcal · calcium · cal tablet

Carbamazepine

Tegretol, Carbamal, Mazetol

Sodium channel blocker (anticonvulsant)

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: avoid (category D; neural tube defects)

INDICATIONS

- G40.9** Epilepsy (focal and generalized tonic-clonic)
- G50.0** Trigeminal neuralgia
- F31.9** Bipolar disorder (acute mania)

ADULT DOSE

100-200 mg BD-TDS (titrate up to 1600 mg/day)

MECHANISM

Blocks voltage-gated sodium channels, stabilizing neuronal membranes

SIDE EFFECTS

Drowsiness, dizziness, ataxia, SIADH, agranulocytosis (rare), severe rash (SJS/TEN especially in Asians with HLA-B*1502), bone marrow suppression

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Bone marrow depression, MAOI use, severe hepatic disease, AV block

PREGNANCY

avoid (category D; neural tube defects)

KEY INTERACTIONS

MAJOR CYP3A4 inducer; reduces efficacy of OCP, warfarin, many drugs

ALSO KNOWN AS

tegretol · carbamazepine · anticonvulsant · epilepsy medicine

Cefixime

Taxim-O, Cefas, Mahacef

3rd-gen cephalosporin

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category B)

INDICATIONS

- N39.0** UTI
- J18.9** Pneumonia
- H66.9** Otitis media
- A09.0** Bacterial dysentery

ADULT DOSE

200 mg BD × 5-7 days (or 400 mg OD)

MECHANISM

Inhibits bacterial cell wall synthesis; resistant to many ;"ÖÆ 7F Ö 6W0

SIDE EFFECTS

Diarrhea, nausea, headache, rash

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Cephalosporin hypersensitivity, severe penicillin allergy (cross-reactivity ~5-10%)

PREGNANCY

safe (category B)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Probenecid, warfarin, OCP

ALSO KNOWN AS

cefixime · cefas · oral cephalosporin

Cetirizine

Cetzine, Zyrtec, CTZ

2nd-gen H1 antihistamine

Schedule OTC OTC Pregnancy: safe (category B)

INDICATIONS

- J30.9 Allergic rhinitis
- L50.9 Urticaria
- L20.9 Atopic dermatitis (adjunct)

ADULT DOSE

10 mg OD

MECHANISM

Selective H1 receptor antagonist (peripheral, less CNS penetration)

SIDE EFFECTS

Drowsiness (less than 1st-gen), dry mouth

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Severe renal impairment (dose adjust)

PREGNANCY

safe (category B)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Few; alcohol (mild sedation)

ALSO KNOWN AS

cezine · zyrtec · antihistamine · allergy medicine · cetirizine

Chlorthalidone

Thalitone, Chlorthalidone, Clorpres

Thiazide-like diuretic (long-acting)

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: avoid (category D)

INDICATIONS

- I10** Hypertension
- I50.9** Heart failure

ADULT DOSE

6.25-25 mg OD

MECHANISM

Same as HCTZ but longer acting (24-72h)

SIDE EFFECTS

Hypokalemia, hyperuricemia, hyperglycemia

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Anuria, sulfa allergy (relative)

PREGNANCY

avoid (category D)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Lithium, digoxin, NSAIDs

ALSO KNOWN AS

chlorthalidone · thalitone · long-acting thiazide · BP medicine

Ciplox-D (Ciprofloxacin + Dexamethasone, ear/eye drops)

Ciplox-D, Ciplox-DX, Ciprodex

Fluoroquinolone + steroid (topical)

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: safe (category C)

INDICATIONS

- H66.9 Otitis externa (with infection)
- H10.9 Conjunctivitis (with infection)

ADULT DOSE

2-3 drops q6-8h ear/eye × 5-7 days

MECHANISM

Antibiotic + corticosteroid for inflammation + infection

SIDE EFFECTS

Local irritation, ototoxicity (rare)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Viral infections (HSV, VZV), perforated tympanic membrane

PREGNANCY

safe (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

None significant (topical)

ALSO KNOWN AS

ciplox-d · ear drops · eye drops · ciprodex

Ciprofloxacin

Cifran, Ciplox, Ciprodac

Fluoroquinolone antibiotic

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: avoid (category C)

INDICATIONS

- N39.0** UTI
- A09.0** Infectious diarrhea
- J18.9** Pneumonia (mild)
- K81.9** Biliary tract infection

ADULT DOSE

250-750 mg BD × 5-7 days (UTI 250-500 mg BD × 3 days)

MECHANISM

Inhibits DNA gyrase and topoisomerase IV; bactericidal

SIDE EFFECTS

Tendon rupture (esp. Achilles), QT prolongation, peripheral neuropathy, photosensitivity, hypoglycemia

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Pregnancy, children < 18, history of tendon disorders with FQ

PREGNANCY

avoid (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Antacids, iron, calcium reduce absorption; warfarin; tizanidine (contraindicated); QT-prolonging drugs

ALSO KNOWN AS

cipro · floxacin · quinolone

Clonazepam

Rivotril, Clonotril, Lonazep

Long-acting benzodiazepine

Schedule H1 **Rx required** Pregnancy: avoid (category D)

INDICATIONS

- F41.1** Anxiety
- G40.9** Epilepsy (adjunct)
- G47.0** REM sleep behavior disorder

ADULT DOSE

0.5-2 mg BD-TDS (max 8 mg/day)

MECHANISM

Potentiates GABA-A

SIDE EFFECTS

Drowsiness, dizziness, ataxia, dependence

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Severe respiratory disease, narrow-angle glaucoma

PREGNANCY

avoid (category D)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Alcohol, opioids, CYP3A4 inhibitors

ALSO KNOWN AS

rivotril · clonotril · lonazep · benzodiazepine · anxiety medicine

Clopidogrel

Plavix, Clopilet, Clopivas

P2Y12 receptor antagonist (antiplatelet)

Schedule H **Rx required** **Pregnancy: avoid (category B)**

INDICATIONS

I21.9 Post-ACS / post-PCI
I63.9 Stroke (secondary prevention)
I20.9 Unstable angina

ADULT DOSE

75 mg OD (loading: 300-600 mg)

MECHANISM

Irreversibly blocks P2Y12 ADP receptor on platelets

SIDE EFFECTS

Bleeding, GI upset, rash, TTP (rare)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Active bleeding, severe hepatic impairment

PREGNANCY

avoid (category B)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Omeprazole/esomeprazole (reduced activation - avoid combo), NSAIDs, warfarin

ALSO KNOWN AS

plavix · clopilet · antiplatelet · blood thinner

Clotrimazole (topical)

Candid, Clotrimazole, Surfaz

Imidazole antifungal (topical)

Schedule OTC OTC Pregnancy: safe (topical)

INDICATIONS

- B35.9** Dermatophytosis (ringworm)
- B37.9** Candidiasis (cutaneous/vulvovaginal)

ADULT DOSE

Apply BD-TDS × 2-4 weeks (skin); single dose (vaginal)

MECHANISM

Inhibits ergosterol synthesis in fungal cell membrane

SIDE EFFECTS

Local irritation, allergic reaction

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hypersensitivity

PREGNANCY

safe (topical)

KEY INTERACTIONS

None significant (topical)

ALSO KNOWN AS

candid · clotrimazole · antifungal cream · ringworm cream

Cough syrup (dextromethorphan + phenylephrine + CPM)

Corex-DX, Benadryl CR, Ascoril-D

Combination antitussive + decongestant + antihistamine

Schedule OTC OTC Pregnancy: avoid (category C; OTC drug concerns)

INDICATIONS

R05 Dry cough with congestion

ADULT DOSE

5-10 mL TDS

MECHANISM

Dextromethorphan = cough suppress; phenylephrine = ; `asoconstrictor (nasal); chlorpheniramine = H1 antagonist

SIDE EFFECTS

Drowsiness, dry mouth, urinary retention, hypertension

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hypertension (phenylephrine), MAOI use, children < 2

PREGNANCY

avoid (category C; OTC drug concerns)

KEY INTERACTIONS

MAOIs, antihypertensives, alcohol, sedatives

ALSO KNOWN AS

corex · benadryl · ascoril · cough syrup · cold syrup

Cyanocobalamin (B12)

Methycobal, Nurokind, B12

Vitamin B12

Schedule OTC OTC Pregnancy: safe (category C)

INDICATIONS

- D51.0 Vitamin B12 deficiency (pernicious anemia)
- G62.9 Peripheral neuropathy (with B12 deficiency)

ADULT DOSE

1 mg IM weekly × 4-6 weeks, then monthly (pernicious anemia); 1-2 mg oral daily

MECHANISM

Essential for myelin synthesis, DNA synthesis, red cell formation

SIDE EFFECTS

Generally safe; rare hypersensitivity

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hypersensitivity, hereditary optic nerve atrophy (Leber disease)

PREGNANCY

safe (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Chloramphenicol, omeprazole, metformin (may reduce B12 levels)

ALSO KNOWN AS

methycobal · nurokind · B12 · neurobion

Dextromethorphan

Benadryl DR, Tussin-DM, Corex-DX

Antitussive (NMDA antagonist, <2Ö vöæ—7B•

Schedule OTC (cough syrups) **OTC** Pregnancy: safe (category C)

INDICATIONS

R05 Dry non-productive cough

ADULT DOSE

10-20 mg q4h (max 120 mg/day)

MECHANISM

Suppresses cough reflex by acting on the cough center in medulla

SIDE EFFECTS

Drowsiness, dizziness, nausea; abuse potential at high doses

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Use with MAOIs, productive cough

PREGNANCY

safe (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

MAOIs (serotonin syndrome), SSRIs, alcohol, opioids

ALSO KNOWN AS

DXM · corex · cough syrup · dry cough medicine

Diclofenac

Voveran, Diclofenac, Zorvolex

NSAID (arylacetic acid)

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: avoid 3rd trimester (category C; D in 3rd trimester)

INDICATIONS

- M25.5** Joint pain
- M54.5** Back pain
- M79.1** Myalgia
- M17.9** Osteoarthritis
- G43.9** Migraine

ADULT DOSE

25-50 mg BD-TDS (oral); 75 mg IM single dose

MECHANISM

Preferentially inhibits COX-2 over COX-1

SIDE EFFECTS

GI upset/ulcer, hepatotoxicity, increased CV risk, fluid retention

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Active GI bleed, severe heart failure, post-CABG, 3rd trimester pregnancy

PREGNANCY

avoid 3rd trimester (category C; D in 3rd trimester)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Warfarin, ACEi, lithium, methotrexate, aspirin

ALSO KNOWN AS

voveran · NSAID · pain killer

Digoxin

Digoxin, Lanoxin, Dixin

Cardiac glycoside (positive inotrope)

Schedule H **Rx required** **Pregnancy: safe (category C)**

INDICATIONS

I50.9 Heart failure (with AF)

I48.9 AF (rate control)

ADULT DOSE

0.125-0.25 mg OD (loading: 0.5-1 mg over 24h)

MECHANISM

Inhibits Na⁺/K⁺ ATPase !' increases intracellular Ca²⁺ z !' positive inotropy; also increases vagal tone

SIDE EFFECTS

Nausea, visual disturbances (yellow halos), arrhythmias (toxicity), bradycardia

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Ventricular fibrillation, severe bradycardia, 2nd/3rd-degree heart block

PREGNANCY

safe (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Amiodarone, verapamil, diltiazem, diuretics (hypokalemia !' toxicity), macrolides

ALSO KNOWN AS

lanoxin · dixin · digoxin · cardiac glycoside

Domperidone

Domstal, Domperi, Motilium

Peripheral D2 antagonist (prokinetic)

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category B; avoid in 1st trimester)

INDICATIONS

- R11** Nausea/vomiting
- K30** Functional dyspepsia
- K21.9** GERD (adjunct)

ADULT DOSE

10 mg TDS before meals (max 30 mg/day)

MECHANISM

Blocks D2 receptors in chemoreceptor trigger zone (CTZ) and upper GI tract

SIDE EFFECTS

Dry mouth, headache, QT prolongation, hyperprolactinemia

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Prolactinoma, severe hepatic impairment, known QT prolongation, GI hemorrhage

PREGNANCY

safe (category B; avoid in 1st trimester)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Ketoconazole, erythromycin (QT prolongation), anticholinergics

ALSO KNOWN AS

domstal · motilium · antiemetic · vomiting medicine

Doxycycline

Doxy, Vibramycin, Doxicip

Tetracycline antibiotic

Schedule H **Rx required** **Pregnancy: avoid (category D)**

INDICATIONS

J18.9	Atypical pneumonia
A09.0	Traveller's diarrhea
A55	Chlamydia
A75.9	Rickettsial infections
L70.0	Acne vulgaris

ADULT DOSE

100 mg BD day 1, then 100 mg OD × 5-7 days

MECHANISM

Binds 30S ribosomal subunit, inhibits protein synthesis

SIDE EFFECTS

Photosensitivity, esophagitis, GI upset, teeth discoloration in children

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Pregnancy, children < 8, severe hepatic disease

PREGNANCY

avoid (category D)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Antacids, iron, calcium, dairy reduce absorption; warfarin; OCP

ALSO KNOWN AS

doxy · vibramycin · tetracycline

Doxycycline + Lactobacillus

Doxycycline-LB, M-Tetra

Tetracycline antibiotic + probiotic

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: avoid

INDICATIONS

A09.0 Diarrhea with antibiotic cover

ADULT DOSE

Doxycycline 100 mg BD + Lactic acid bacillus (varies by brand)

MECHANISM

Antibiotic + probiotic to prevent antibiotic-associated diarrhea

SIDE EFFECTS

See doxycycline; less GI upset with probiotic

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Pregnancy, children < 8

PREGNANCY

avoid

KEY INTERACTIONS

See doxycycline

ALSO KNOWN AS

doxy-lb · doxycycline combo · antidiarrheal antibiotic

Empagliflozin

Jardiance, Empa, Glyxambi

SGLT2 inhibitor (gliflozin)

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: avoid (2nd/3rd trimester)

INDICATIONS

- E11.9** Type 2 DM
- I50.9** Heart failure (with/without DM)
- N18.9** CKD (with DM)

ADULT DOSE

10-25 mg OD

MECHANISM

Inhibits SGLT2 in renal tubules !' increases glucose excretion

SIDE EFFECTS

UTI, genital mycotic infections, euglycemic DKA, volume depletion, Fournier's gangrene (rare)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Type 1 DM, eGFR < 20, severe renal impairment

PREGNANCY

avoid (2nd/3rd trimester)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Diuretics (volume depletion), insulin (hypoglycemia), rifampin (decreases efficacy)

ALSO KNOWN AS

jardiance · SGLT2 · gliflozin · diabetes medicine

Enalapril

Envas, Enace, Vasotec

ACE inhibitor

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: CONTRAINDICATED (category D)

INDICATIONS

- I10 Hypertension
- I50.9 Heart failure
- E11.9 Diabetic nephropathy

ADULT DOSE

5-20 mg OD-BD

MECHANISM

Inhibits ACE, reducing angiotensin II formation and bradykinin breakdown

SIDE EFFECTS

Dry cough (very common), hyperkalemia, angioedema, hypotension, taste disturbance

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Bilateral renal artery stenosis, pregnancy, angioedema history

PREGNANCY

CONTRAINDICATED (category D)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Potassium-sparing diuretics, lithium, NSAIDs, sacubitril

ALSO KNOWN AS

envas · vasotec · ACE inhibitor · BP medicine

Escitalopram

Lexapro, Nexito, S-Celepra
SSRI

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category C; paroxetine preferred to avoid)

INDICATIONS

F32.9 Major depression
F41.1 Generalized anxiety

ADULT DOSE

10-20 mg OD

MECHANISM

S-enantiomer of citalopram; SSRI

SIDE EFFECTS

Nausea, sexual dysfunction, insomnia, QT prolongation (dose-dependent)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

MAOI use, pimozide

PREGNANCY

safe (category C; paroxetine preferred to avoid)

KEY INTERACTIONS

MAOIs, NSAIDs, warfarin, QT-prolonging drugs

ALSO KNOWN AS

lexapro · nexito · SSRI · antidepressant

Famotidine

Famocid, Pepcid, Topcid

H2 receptor antagonist

Schedule OTC OTC Pregnancy: safe (category B)

INDICATIONS

- K21.9 GERD (mild)
- K29.7 Gastritis
- K27.9 Peptic ulcer

ADULT DOSE

20-40 mg BD or 40 mg HS

MECHANISM

Competitively blocks H2 receptors

SIDE EFFECTS

Headache, constipation, dizziness

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hypersensitivity

PREGNANCY

safe (category B)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Ketoconazole, atazanavir (reduced absorption)

ALSO KNOWN AS

pepcid · H2 blocker · famocid

Febuxostat

Febuget, Febuxor, Uloric

Xanthine oxidase inhibitor (non-purine)

Schedule H **Rx required** **Pregnancy: avoid (limited data)**

INDICATIONS

M10.9 Chronic gout (especially if allopurinol intolerant)

ADULT DOSE

40-80 mg OD

MECHANISM

Same as allopurinol but non-purine structure

SIDE EFFECTS

Liver function abnormalities, nausea, joint pain, CV events (warning)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Asymptomatic hyperuricemia, severe hepatic disease, concomitant azathioprine

PREGNANCY

avoid (limited data)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Azathioprine, mercaptopurine, theophylline

ALSO KNOWN AS

febuget · febuxostat · gout medicine

Ferrous sulfate (oral)

Fefol, Livogen, Orofer

Oral iron supplement

Schedule OTC OTC Pregnancy: safe (category A; standard in pregnancy)

INDICATIONS

D50.9 Iron deficiency anemia

ADULT DOSE

200 mg BD-TDS ("H 60-100 mg elemental Fe/day)

MECHANISM

Provides elemental iron for hemoglobin synthesis

SIDE EFFECTS

GI upset, constipation, dark stools

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hemochromatosis, hemosiderosis, repeated transfusions

PREGNANCY

safe (category A; standard in pregnancy)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Calcium, antacids, tea, coffee reduce absorption; vitamin C increases; tetracyclines (reduced absorption)

ALSO KNOWN AS

livogen · fefol · iron tablet · anemia medicine

Fexofenadine

Allegra, Fexova, Fexigra

2nd-gen H1 antihistamine (non-sedating)

Schedule OTC OTC Pregnancy: safe (category C)

INDICATIONS

J30.9 Allergic rhinitis
L50.9 Urticaria

ADULT DOSE

120-180 mg OD

MECHANISM

Selective H1 receptor antagonist; minimal CNS penetration

SIDE EFFECTS

Headache, GI upset, rare drowsiness

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hypersensitivity

PREGNANCY

safe (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Antacids (aluminum/magnesium - reduce absorption), fruit juices (decrease AUC)

ALSO KNOWN AS

allegra · fexo · antihistamine · allergy medicine

Fluconazole

Diflucan, Flucos, Zocon

Triazole antifungal

Schedule H **Rx required** **Pregnancy: avoid (category C, high dose contraindicated)**

INDICATIONS

- B37.3** Vulvovaginal candidiasis
- B37.9** Candidiasis (oral/esophageal)
- B49** Systemic fungal infection

ADULT DOSE

150 mg single dose (vaginal candidiasis), 200-400 mg OD × 2-4 weeks (systemic)

MECHANISM

Inhibits ergosterol synthesis (fungal cell membrane)

SIDE EFFECTS

Hepatotoxicity, GI upset, QT prolongation, headache

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Pregnancy (high dose), severe hepatic disease, co-administration with terfenadine

PREGNANCY

avoid (category C, high dose contraindicated)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Warfarin, phenytoin, rifampin (decreases fluconazole), QT-prolonging drugs

ALSO KNOWN AS

diflucan · azole antifungal · candidiasis

Folic acid

Folvite, Foline, Folat

B vitamin (folate)

Schedule OTC OTC Pregnancy: safe (category A; first-line prevention of NTD)

INDICATIONS

- D52.0 Folate deficiency anemia
- O26.9 Pregnancy supplementation
- Z00.0 Pre-conception (NTD prevention)

ADULT DOSE

5 mg OD (therapeutic); 400-800 mcg OD (prevention in pregnancy)

MECHANISM

Essential cofactor for DNA synthesis and methylation

SIDE EFFECTS

Generally safe; rare GI upset, masks B12 deficiency

CONTRAINDICATIONS

B12 deficiency (masks neurologic damage), pernicious anemia

PREGNANCY

safe (category A; first-line prevention of NTD)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Methotrexate (antagonizes), phenytoin, sulfasalazine, TMP-SMX

ALSO KNOWN AS

folvite · folic · pregnancy vitamin · folate

Furosemide

Lasix, Frusemide, Lasix

Loop diuretic

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category C; use only if needed)

INDICATIONS

- I50.9** Heart failure (decompensated)
- N18.9** Chronic kidney disease (with edema)
- K76.6** Cirrhosis with ascites

ADULT DOSE

20-80 mg OD-BD (oral); 20-40 mg IV/IM for acute pulmonary edema

MECHANISM

Inhibits Na⁺/K⁺/2Cl⁻ cotransporter in thick ascending limb of loop of Henle

SIDE EFFECTS

Hypokalemia, hypomagnesemia, ototoxicity (high dose IV), volume depletion

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Anuria, severe electrolyte depletion

PREGNANCY

safe (category C; use only if needed)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Aminoglycosides (ototoxicity), lithium, digoxin, NSAIDs

ALSO KNOWN AS

lasix · frusemide · loop diuretic · water pill

Glimepiride

Amaryl, Glimer, Glypride

Sulfonylurea (insulin secretagogue)

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: avoid (category C; use insulin)

INDICATIONS

E11.9 Type 2 DM (after metformin)

ADULT DOSE

1-8 mg OD (before breakfast)

MECHANISM

Closes K+ channels in pancreatic ;" 6VÆÇ2 " FW öÆ ization !' insulin release

SIDE EFFECTS

Hypoglycemia, weight gain, GI upset

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Type 1 DM, severe hepatic/renal impairment

PREGNANCY

avoid (category C; use insulin)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Sulfonylureas, alcohol, ;"Ö lockers (mask hypoglycemia), CYP2C9 inhibitors

ALSO KNOWN AS

amaryl · glimepiride · sulfonylurea · diabetes medicine

Glipizide

Glynase, Glide, Diabetrol

Sulfonylurea (short-acting)

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: avoid (category C)

INDICATIONS

E11.9 Type 2 DM

ADULT DOSE

2.5-20 mg OD-BD, 30 min before meals

MECHANISM

Same as glimepiride

SIDE EFFECTS

Hypoglycemia, weight gain

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Type 1 DM, severe hepatic/renal impairment

PREGNANCY

avoid (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Same as glimepiride

ALSO KNOWN AS

glynase · glipizide · sulfonylurea

Glyceryl Trinitrate (GTN, sublingual)

Sorbitrate, Anginil, Nitrocontin

Organic nitrate (rapid-acting)

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: safe (category C)

INDICATIONS

- I20.9 Acute angina attack
- I21.9 Acute coronary syndrome (initial)

ADULT DOSE

0.5 mg sublingual, repeat q5min × 3 if needed

MECHANISM

Same as isosorbide; rapid onset sublingually

SIDE EFFECTS

Headache, hypotension, reflex tachycardia

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Sildenafil use, severe hypotension, severe anemia

PREGNANCY

safe (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

PDE-5 inhibitors (severe hypotension), antihypertensives

ALSO KNOWN AS

GTN · nitroglycerin · sorbitrate · angina emergency medicine

Guaifenesin

Mucinex, Glycodin, Benadryl CR

Expectorant

Schedule OTC OTC Pregnancy: safe (category C)

INDICATIONS

R05 Productive cough (loosen mucus)

ADULT DOSE

200-400 mg q4h (max 2400 mg/day)

MECHANISM

Increases respiratory tract fluid secretions, reducing mucus viscosity

SIDE EFFECTS

Nausea, vomiting, headache

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Chronic cough (smoking, asthma, emphysema)

PREGNANCY

safe (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

None significant

ALSO KNOWN AS

guaiphenesin · mucinex · expectorant · cough medicine

Hydrochloroquine (HCQ)

HCQS, Plaquenil, Hydroquin

DMARD / antimalarial

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category D; but actually safe in SLE/RA — risk of flare vs minor fetal risk)

INDICATIONS

- M32.9** SLE
- M06.9** Rheumatoid arthritis
- B54** Malaria (treatment & prophylaxis)

ADULT DOSE

200-400 mg OD

MECHANISM

Multiple: lysosomal pH modulation, TLR inhibition, immunomodulation

SIDE EFFECTS

Retinal toxicity (long-term, dose-related), QT prolongation, GI upset, skin pigmentation

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Pre-existing retinopathy, G6PD deficiency, severe hepatic disease

PREGNANCY

safe (category D; but actually safe in SLE/RA — risk of flare vs minor fetal risk)

KEY INTERACTIONS

QT-prolonging drugs, amiodarone, cyclosporine

ALSO KNOWN AS

HCQS · plaquenil · antimalarial · DMARD · SLE medicine · RA medicine

Hydrochlorothiazide

HCTZ, Aquazide, Esidrix

Thiazide diuretic

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: avoid (category D; older antihypertensives)

INDICATIONS

- I10 Hypertension (first-line)
- I50.9 Heart failure (mild)

ADULT DOSE

12.5-25 mg OD (morning)

MECHANISM

Inhibits Na⁺/Cl⁻ cotransporter in distal convoluted tubule

SIDE EFFECTS

Hypokalemia, hyponatremia, hyperuricemia (gout), hyperglycemia, photosensitivity

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Anuria, severe renal impairment, sulfa allergy (relative)

PREGNANCY

avoid (category D; older antihypertensives)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Lithium (toxicity), digoxin (hypokalemia), NSAIDs

ALSO KNOWN AS

HCTZ · thiazide · water pill · BP medicine

Hydroxychloroquine (SLE)

HCQS 200, Plaquenil

DMARD / antimalarial

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe in pregnancy SLE/RA (continued use reduces flare)

INDICATIONS

- M32.9 SLE
- M32.10 SLE with organ involvement

ADULT DOSE

200-400 mg OD (max 6.5 mg/kg/day)

MECHANISM

Immunomodulatory; inhibits TLR signaling, modifies antigen presentation

SIDE EFFECTS

Retinopathy (cumulative dose), GI upset, skin hyperpigmentation, QT prolongation

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Pre-existing retinopathy, severe hepatic disease, G6PD deficiency

PREGNANCY

safe in pregnancy SLE/RA (continued use reduces flare)

KEY INTERACTIONS

QT-prolonging drugs, amiodarone, cyclosporine

ALSO KNOWN AS

HCQS · plaquenil · SLE medicine · malaria medicine

Ibuprofen

Brufen, Ibugesic, Advil

NSAID (propionic acid)

Schedule OTC OTC Pregnancy: avoid 3rd trimester (category C; D in 3rd trimester)

INDICATIONS

- R51 Headache
- M79.1 Myalgia
- M54.5 Low back pain
- M25.5 Joint pain
- N94.6 Dysmenorrhea
- R50.9 Fever

ADULT DOSE

200-400 mg q6-8h (max 1200 mg/day OTC; 2400 mg/day Rx)

MECHANISM

Reversibly inhibits COX-1 and COX-2, reducing prostaglandin synthesis

SIDE EFFECTS

GI upset, ulcer, renal impairment, increased CV risk, fluid retention

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Active peptic ulcer, severe renal/hepatic impairment, 3rd trimester pregnancy, post-CABG

PREGNANCY

avoid 3rd trimester (category C; D in 3rd trimester)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Warfarin, ACE inhibitors, lithium, methotrexate, aspirin

ALSO KNOWN AS

brufen · NSAID · pain killer · fever medicine

Insulin (regular, NPH, glargine, aspart)

Huminsulin, Mixtard, Lantus, NovoRapid, Apidra

Hormone (antidiabetic)

Schedule H **Rx required** **Pregnancy: safe (insulin = gold standard in pregnancy)**

INDICATIONS

E10.9 Type 1 DM
E11.9 Type 2 DM (advanced)
O24.4 Gestational DM

ADULT DOSE

Titrated to glucose targets (basal-bolus, premixed, sliding scale)

MECHANISM

Replaces endogenous insulin; promotes cellular glucose uptake, glycogen synthesis, lipogenesis

SIDE EFFECTS

Hypoglycemia, weight gain, lipodystrophy at injection site

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hypoglycemia

PREGNANCY

safe (insulin = gold standard in pregnancy)

KEY INTERACTIONS

β-blockers (mask hypoglycemia), corticosteroids, thiazides (raise glucose), alcohol

ALSO KNOWN AS

insulin · lantus · novorapid · huminsulin · mixtard · diabetes medicine

Ipratropium bromide

Ipravent, Atrovent, Duolin (with salbutamol)

Short-acting antimuscarinic (SAMA)

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: safe (category B)

INDICATIONS

- J44.9 COPD
- J45.9 Asthma (adjunct in exacerbation)

ADULT DOSE

2-4 puffs q6h (MDI); 500 mcg neb q6-8h

MECHANISM

Muscarinic antagonist in airways, blocks vagally-mediated bronchoconstriction

SIDE EFFECTS

Dry mouth, urinary retention, constipation, blurred vision

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hypersensitivity to atropine

PREGNANCY

safe (category B)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Anticholinergics (additive effects)

ALSO KNOWN AS

ipravent · atrovent · inhaler · duolin · COPD medicine

Iron sucrose (IV)

Orofer-S, Ferric, Encicarb

Parenteral iron

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: safe (category B; after 1st trimester if needed)

INDICATIONS

D50.9 Iron deficiency anemia (oral intolerance or severe)

ADULT DOSE

100-200 mg IV slow push or infusion (max 1000 mg/week)

MECHANISM

Replenishes iron stores; incorporated into hemoglobin

SIDE EFFECTS

Hypotension, hypersensitivity reactions, GI upset

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Anemia not due to iron deficiency, hypersensitivity

PREGNANCY

safe (category B; after 1st trimester if needed)

KEY INTERACTIONS

None significant with single IV dose

ALSO KNOWN AS

iron sucrose · IV iron · anemia medicine

Isosorbide Mononitrate

Imdur, Monotrate, Ismo

Organic nitrate (vasodilator)

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: safe (category C)

INDICATIONS

- I20.9 Chronic stable angina
- I50.9 Heart failure (adjunct)

ADULT DOSE

20-60 mg OD-BD (asymmetric dosing to avoid tolerance)

MECHANISM

Releases nitric oxide !' activates guanylate cyclase !' vasodilation (mainly venous)

SIDE EFFECTS

Headache, hypotension, flushing, tolerance (with continuous exposure)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Concomitant PDE-5 inhibitors (sildenafil), severe hypotension, severe anemia

PREGNANCY

safe (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Sildenafil/tadalafil, antihypertensives, alcohol

ALSO KNOWN AS

imdur · monotrate · ISMN · nitrate · angina medicine

Ivermectin

Ivecop, Iverheal, Ivermectol

Antiparasitic (avermectin)

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: CONTRAINDICATED

INDICATIONS

- B73** Onchocerciasis (river blindness)
- B86** Scabies (topical/oral)
- B76.9** Strongyloidiasis

ADULT DOSE

150-200 mcg/kg single dose (onchocerciasis, scabies); repeat in 1-2 weeks

MECHANISM

Binds glutamate-gated Cl⁻ channels in invertebrates, paralyzing parasites

SIDE EFFECTS

Mazzotti reaction (in onchocerciasis), pruritus, fever, lymphadenopathy

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Pregnancy, breastfeeding, children < 5 (<15 kg)

PREGNANCY

CONTRAINDICATED

KEY INTERACTIONS

CYP3A4 substrates

ALSO KNOWN AS

ivermectin · ivecop · scabies medicine

Lactulose

Lactulose, Duphalac, Evaculose

Osmotic laxative (synthetic disaccharide)

Schedule OTC OTC Pregnancy: safe (category B)

INDICATIONS

- K59.0** Constipation
- K72.9** Hepatic encephalopathy

ADULT DOSE

15-30 mL OD-BD

MECHANISM

Osmotic retention of water in colon; also acidifies colon, traps ammonia

SIDE EFFECTS

Bloating, flatulence, abdominal cramps

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Galactosemia, intestinal obstruction

PREGNANCY

safe (category B)

KEY INTERACTIONS

May reduce activity of oral neomycin

ALSO KNOWN AS

duphalac · lactulose · constipation medicine

Levetiracetam

Levipil, Keppra, Levera

Anticonvulsant (SV2A modulator)

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category C; preferred AED in pregnancy)

INDICATIONS

G40.9 Epilepsy (adjunct and monotherapy)

ADULT DOSE

500-1500 mg BD

MECHANISM

Binds SV2A synaptic vesicle protein (modulates neurotransmitter release)

SIDE EFFECTS

Drowsiness, dizziness, behavioral changes (irritability, depression), headache

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hypersensitivity

PREGNANCY

safe (category C; preferred AED in pregnancy)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Few; minimal hepatic metabolism

ALSO KNOWN AS

levipil · keppra · levetiracetam · anticonvulsant · epilepsy medicine

Levocetirizine

Xyzal, Vozet, Teczine

2nd-gen H1 antihistamine (active enantiomer)

Schedule OTC **OTC** Pregnancy: avoid (limited data)

INDICATIONS

J30.9 Allergic rhinitis
L50.9 Urticaria

ADULT DOSE

5 mg OD

MECHANISM

Active R-enantiomer of cetirizine

SIDE EFFECTS

Drowsiness, dry mouth (less than 1st-gen)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Severe renal impairment

PREGNANCY

avoid (limited data)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Alcohol, CNS depressants

ALSO KNOWN AS

xyzal · levocet · antihistamine · allergy medicine

Levothyroxine

Eltroxin, Lethyrox, Thyronorm, Euthyrox

Thyroid hormone (T4)

Schedule H **Rx required** **Pregnancy: safe (category A; dose often increases in pregnancy)**

INDICATIONS

- E03.9** Hypothyroidism (primary)
- E89.0** Post-thyroidectomy hypothyroidism
- E06.3** Hashimoto thyroiditis

ADULT DOSE

25-200 mcg OD (on empty stomach, 30-60 min before breakfast)

MECHANISM

Replaces deficient endogenous thyroxine (T4); converted to T3 in periphery

SIDE EFFECTS

Palpitations, tremor, insomnia, weight loss (if over-replaced)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Untreated adrenal insufficiency, recent MI, thyrotoxicosis

PREGNANCY

safe (category A; dose often increases in pregnancy)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Calcium, iron, antacids (reduce absorption - take 4h apart), warfarin, OCP

ALSO KNOWN AS

eltroxin · thyronorm · thyroid medicine · thyroxine

Loperamide

Loperamide, Imodium, Lopamide

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Schedule OTC **OTC** **Pregnancy:** safe (category B)

INDICATIONS

A09.0 Acute diarrhea (non-infectious)

ADULT DOSE

4 mg initial, then 2 mg after each loose stool (max 16 mg/day)

MECHANISM

Slows intestinal transit, increases water/electrolyte absorption

SIDE EFFECTS

Constipation, abdominal cramps; rare cardiac events with high doses

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Acute dysentery, C. difficile colitis, children < 2

PREGNANCY

safe (category B)

KEY INTERACTIONS

P-gp inhibitors (quinidine, verapamil), QT-prolonging drugs

ALSO KNOWN AS

imodium · lopamide · anti-diarrheal · loose motion medicine

Losartan

Losar, Cozaar, Losakind

ARB

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: CONTRAINDICATED (category D)

INDICATIONS

- I10 Hypertension
- I50.9 Heart failure
- E11.9 Diabetic nephropathy
- I63.9 Stroke prevention (in HTN with LVH)

ADULT DOSE

50-100 mg OD-BD

MECHANISM

Selectively blocks AT1 receptor

SIDE EFFECTS

Dizziness, hyperkalemia, hypotension, fatigue

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Bilateral renal artery stenosis, pregnancy, hyperkalemia

PREGNANCY

CONTRAINDICATED (category D)

KEY INTERACTIONS

ACEi (avoid), potassium-sparing diuretics, NSAIDs, lithium

ALSO KNOWN AS

losar · cozaar · ARB · BP medicine

Metformin

Glycomet, Glucophage, Gluconorm, Metformin

Biguanide (insulin sensitizer)

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: safe (category B; first-line in gestational/preexisting DM in pregnancy)

INDICATIONS

- E11.9** Type 2 diabetes mellitus
- E66.9** Obesity (with DM)
- E28.2** PCOS (off-label)

ADULT DOSE

500 mg BD-TDS (max 2 g/day), with meals

MECHANISM

Decreases hepatic gluconeogenesis, increases peripheral insulin sensitivity

SIDE EFFECTS

GI upset (very common), lactic acidosis (rare, with renal impairment), B12 deficiency

CONTRAINDICATIONS

eGFR < 30, acute heart failure, severe hepatic disease, alcoholism

PREGNANCY

safe (category B; first-line in gestational/preexisting DM in pregnancy)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Iodinated contrast (hold 48h), cimetidine, alcohol

ALSO KNOWN AS

glycomet · glucophage · gluconorm · diabetes medicine · sugar medicine

Methotrexate (low dose)

Folitrax, Mexate, Imutrex

Antimetabolite / DMARD

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: CONTRAINDICATED (category X; highly teratogenic)

INDICATIONS

- M06.9 Rheumatoid arthritis
- L40.0 Psoriasis
- M32.9 SLE

ADULT DOSE

7.5-25 mg ONCE WEEKLY (with folic acid 5 mg weekly)

MECHANISM

Inhibits dihydrofolate reductase (folate antagonist); also has anti-inflammatory effects at low dose

SIDE EFFECTS

Hepatotoxicity, bone marrow suppression, pulmonary toxicity, mucositis, teratogenicity

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Pregnancy (abortifacient, teratogenic), breastfeeding, severe hepatic/renal disease, active infection

PREGNANCY

CONTRAINDICATED (category X; highly teratogenic)

KEY INTERACTIONS

NSAIDs (reduce clearance), trimethoprim (additive anti-folate), alcohol (hepatotoxicity)

ALSO KNOWN AS

folitrax · methotrexate · DMARD · arthritis medicine · RA medicine

Metoprolol

Metolar, Toprol, Betaloc

β₁ selective blocker

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category C)

INDICATIONS

- I10** Hypertension
- I20.9** Angina
- I21.9** Post-MI
- I50.9** Heart failure (compensated)

ADULT DOSE

25-200 mg OD-BD (extended release)

MECHANISM

Competitive β₁ antagonist

SIDE EFFECTS

Bradycardia, fatigue, dizziness, depression, bronchospasm

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Severe bradycardia, heart block, severe asthma, decompensated HF

PREGNANCY

safe (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Verapamil/diltiazem, CYP2D6 inhibitors (paroxetine), clonidine

ALSO KNOWN AS

metolar · toprol · beta blocker · BP medicine

Metronidazole

Flagyl, Metrogyl, Metrogyl IV

Nitroimidazole antimicrobial

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: avoid in 1st trimester (category B)

INDICATIONS

- A04.7** C. difficile colitis
- A59.0** Trichomoniasis
- A06.0** Amoebiasis
- K81.9** Anaerobic infections
- L08.9** Bacterial vaginosis

ADULT DOSE

400-500 mg TDS × 5-7 days (or 2 g single dose for trichomoniasis)

MECHANISM

Reduced to reactive nitro radical, damages bacterial DNA (anaerobes only)

SIDE EFFECTS
Metallic taste, nausea, disulfiram-like reaction with alcohol, peripheral neuropathy (long-term)

CONTRAINDICATIONS
Pregnancy 1st trimester, severe hepatic disease

PREGNANCY
avoid in 1st trimester (category B)

KEY INTERACTIONS
Alcohol (disulfiram reaction), warfarin, lithium, disulfiram

ALSO KNOWN AS
flagyl · metro · anaerobic

Montelukast

Montair, Singulair, Montel

Leukotriene receptor antagonist

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: safe (category B)

INDICATIONS

J45.9 Asthma (adjunct)
J30.9 Allergic rhinitis

ADULT DOSE

10 mg OD (HS)

MECHANISM

Selectively blocks cysteinyl leukotriene-1 receptor

SIDE EFFECTS

Headache, abdominal pain, neuropsychiatric effects (rare: depression, suicidality in adults)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hypersensitivity

PREGNANCY

safe (category B)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Phenobarbital, rifampin (decrease levels)

ALSO KNOWN AS

montair · singulair · LTRA · asthma medicine · leukotriene

Mupirocin

T-Bact, Mupinase, Mupirocin

Topical antibiotic (*pseudomonic acid A*)

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category B)

INDICATIONS

- L08.9** Impetigo
- L02.9** Folliculitis (mild)
- L73.8** Erythrasma

ADULT DOSE

Apply TDS × 5-14 days

MECHANISM

Inhibits bacterial isoleucyl-tRNA synthetase (Gram-positive only)

SIDE EFFECTS

Local irritation, burning

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hypersensitivity, large area use (polyethylene glycol base)

PREGNANCY

safe (category B)

KEY INTERACTIONS

None significant

ALSO KNOWN AS

T-Bact · mupirocin · impetigo cream · antibiotic ointment

Naproxen

Naprosyn, Xenobid, Aleve

NSAID (propionic acid, long-acting)

Schedule OTC (low dose) **Rx required** Pregnancy: avoid 3rd trimester (category C)

INDICATIONS

- M25.5** Joint pain
- M54.5** Back pain
- N94.6** Dysmenorrhea
- R51** Headache

ADULT DOSE

250-500 mg BD (max 1000 mg/day)

MECHANISM

Long-acting reversible COX inhibitor

SIDE EFFECTS

GI upset/ulcer, renal impairment, CV risk

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Active GI bleed, severe renal impairment, 3rd trimester

PREGNANCY

avoid 3rd trimester (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Warfarin, ACEi, lithium, aspirin

ALSO KNOWN AS

naprosyn · NSAID · pain killer

Omeprazole

Omez, Omecip, Prilosec, Losec

Proton pump inhibitor (PPI)

Schedule OTC (low dose) **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category C)

INDICATIONS

- K21.9** GERD
- K29.7** Gastritis
- K27.9** Peptic ulcer
- K22.7** Barrett's esophagus

ADULT DOSE

20-40 mg OD (before breakfast) × 4-8 weeks

MECHANISM

Irreversibly inhibits H+/K+ ATPase in gastric parietal cells

SIDE EFFECTS

Headache, diarrhea, B12 deficiency (long-term), hypomagnesemia, increased fracture risk

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Concomitant use with rilpivirine, nelfinavir

PREGNANCY

safe (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Clopidogrel (decreased activation), methotrexate, diazepam, phenytoin

ALSO KNOWN AS

PPI · omez · gastric · acid reflux · heartburn medicine

Ondansetron

Emeset, Zofran, Ondem

5-HT3 antagonist (antiemetic)

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: safe (category B)

INDICATIONS

- R11 Nausea/vomiting (chemo, post-op)
- R11.2 Pregnancy nausea (severe)

ADULT DOSE

4-8 mg TDS (chemo: 8 mg IV pre and q8h)

MECHANISM

Blocks 5-HT3 receptors in CTZ and gut

SIDE EFFECTS
Constipation, headache, QT prolongation, serotonin syndrome

CONTRAINDICATIONS
Apomorphine use, severe hepatic impairment

PREGNANCY
safe (category B)

KEY INTERACTIONS
Apomorphine, QT-prolonging drugs, tramadol (serotonin syndrome)

ALSO KNOWN AS
zofran · emeset · antiemetic · vomiting medicine

Oral Rehydration Salts (ORS)

Electral, ORS, WHO-ORS

Electrolyte/glucose solution

Schedule OTC OTC Pregnancy: safe

INDICATIONS

- A09.0 Acute gastroenteritis
- K52.9 Diarrhea (any cause)

ADULT DOSE

1 packet in 1 L water; sip 200-400 ml after each loose stool

MECHANISM

Replaces water, sodium, potassium, glucose lost in diarrhea; glucose drives Na+ absorption

SIDE EFFECTS

Generally safe; rare hypernatremia if over-concentrated

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Ileus, intestinal obstruction

PREGNANCY

safe

KEY INTERACTIONS

None significant

ALSO KNOWN AS

electral · ORS · rehydration · loose motion

Oseltamivir

Tamiflu, Fluvir, Antiflu

Neuraminidase inhibitor

Schedule H

Rx required

Pregnancy: safe (category B); consider benefits vs risk in severe flu

INDICATIONS

J10.1 Influenza A/B

ADULT DOSE

75 mg BD × 5 days (start within 48h of symptoms)

MECHANISM

Inhibits viral neuraminidase, prevents release of new virions

SIDE EFFECTS

Nausea, vomiting, headache (usually mild)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Severe renal impairment (dose adjust)

PREGNANCY

safe (category B); consider benefits vs risk in severe flu

KEY INTERACTIONS

Live attenuated influenza vaccine (within 48h)

ALSO KNOWN AS

tamiflu · flu antiviral · H1N1

Pantoprazole

Pantocid, Pantop, Protonix

PPI

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category B)

INDICATIONS

- K21.9** GERD
- K29.7** Gastritis
- K27.9** Peptic ulcer

ADULT DOSE

40 mg OD before breakfast

MECHANISM

Irreversibly inhibits H+/K+ ATPase

SIDE EFFECTS

Headache, diarrhea, B12 deficiency (long-term)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hypersensitivity

PREGNANCY

safe (category B)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Methotrexate, atazanavir, ketoconazole/itraconazole (reduced absorption)

ALSO KNOWN AS

pantocid · PPI · acid reflux

Paracetamol (Acetaminophen)

Calpol, Crocin, Dolo, Tylenol

Non-opioid analgesic / antipyretic

Schedule OTC OTC Pregnancy: safe (category A; first-line analgesic)

INDICATIONS

- R50.9 Fever
- R51 Headache
- R52.1 Mild-moderate pain
- M79.1 Myalgia

ADULT DOSE

500-1000 mg q6-8h (max 4 g/day)

MECHANISM

Inhibits CNS prostaglandin synthesis; weak peripheral COX inhibition

SIDE EFFECTS

Hepatotoxicity at >10 g/day, rare skin reactions (SJS)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Severe hepatic impairment, active liver disease

PREGNANCY

safe (category A; first-line analgesic)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Alcohol (hepatotoxicity), warfarin (high dose), isoniazid

ALSO KNOWN AS

acetaminophen · crocin · dolo · calpol · PCM · tylenol · fever medicine

Phenytoin

Dilantin, Eptoin, Phenytoin

Sodium channel blocker (anticonvulsant)

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: avoid (fetal hydantoin syndrome; category D)

INDICATIONS

G40.9 Epilepsy (generalized tonic-clonic, focal)
R25.2 Status epilepticus (IV)

ADULT DOSE

100 mg TDS (or 15-20 mg/kg IV loading)

MECHANISM

Blocks voltage-gated sodium channels (use-dependent)

SIDE EFFECTS

Gingival hyperplasia, nystagmus, ataxia, hirsutism, folate deficiency, osteoporosis, severe rash

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Sinus bradycardia, heart block, severe hepatic disease

PREGNANCY

avoid (fetal hydantoin syndrome; category D)

KEY INTERACTIONS

CYP450 inducer (reduces OCP, warfarin, etc.), many

ALSO KNOWN AS

dilantin · eptoin · phenytoin · anticonvulsant · epilepsy medicine

Prednisolone

Omnacortil, Wysolone, Predone

Synthetic glucocorticoid

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category C; use if needed)

INDICATIONS

- J45.9** Severe asthma (exacerbation)
- M32.9** SLE (flare)
- M06.9** Rheumatoid arthritis (flare)
- L20.9** Severe eczema

ADULT DOSE

5-60 mg OD (lowest effective dose, shortest duration)

MECHANISM

Binds glucocorticoid receptor !' broad anti-inflammatory and immunosuppressive effects

SIDE EFFECTS

Weight gain, hyperglycemia, osteoporosis, cataracts, mood changes, adrenal suppression (long-term), immunosuppression, Cushingoid

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Systemic infection (unless covered), live vaccines

PREGNANCY

safe (category C; use if needed)

KEY INTERACTIONS

NSAIDs (GI bleed), vaccines, CYP3A4 inducers, warfarin, antidiabetics

ALSO KNOWN AS

omnacortil · wysolone · prednisolone · steroid · PCS

Propranolol

Ciplar, Inderal, Betacap

Non-selective ;"Ö locker

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category C)

INDICATIONS

- I10 Hypertension
- I20.9 Angina
- G43.9 Migraine prophylaxis
- E05.9 Hyperthyroidism (symptomatic)
- F41.1 Anxiety (situational)

ADULT DOSE

10-40 mg BD-TDS (cardiac); 10-40 mg TDS (migraine prophylaxis)

MECHANISM

Non-selective ;"Ö G&VæW&v-2 çF vöæ-7@

SIDE EFFECTS

Bradycardia, bronchospasm, cold extremities, fatigue, nightmares

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Severe asthma, severe bradycardia, heart block, decompensated HF

PREGNANCY

safe (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Verapamil, insulin (masks hypoglycemia), clonidine

ALSO KNOWN AS

ciplar · inderal · beta blocker · propranolol · migraine medicine

Ranitidine (withdrawn in many countries)

Zinetac, Rantac (now mostly discontinued)

H2 receptor antagonist

Schedule OTC (recalled NDMA) OTC Pregnancy: safe (category B)

INDICATIONS

- K21.9 GERD (mild)
- K29.7 Gastritis (mild)

ADULT DOSE

150 mg BD (was standard)

MECHANISM

Competitively blocks H2 receptors in gastric parietal cells

SIDE EFFECTS

NDMA contamination (carcinogenic) led to global withdrawal; constipation, headache

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hypersensitivity

PREGNANCY

safe (category B)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Ketoconazole, atazanavir (reduced absorption)

ALSO KNOWN AS

zantac · H2 blocker · heartburn

Rosuvastatin

Rosuvas, Crestor, Rosave

Statin (more potent, less CYP metabolism)

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: CONTRAINDICATED (category X)

INDICATIONS

E78.5 Hypercholesterolemia
I21.9 Post-MI (high-risk patients)

ADULT DOSE

5-40 mg HS

MECHANISM

Inhibits HMG-CoA reductase (less CYP3A4 metabolism = fewer drug interactions)

SIDE EFFECTS

Myalgia, rhabdomyolysis, elevated LFTs, proteinuria

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Active liver disease, pregnancy

PREGNANCY

CONTRAINDICATED (category X)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Cyclosporine, gemfibrozil, antacids (reduce absorption)

ALSO KNOWN AS

rosuvas · crestor · statin

Salbutamol (Albuterol)

Asthalin, Ventolin, Salbair

Short-acting ;#"Ö vöæ—7B ...4 \$ •

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: safe (category C; preferred in pregnancy asthma)

INDICATIONS

- J45.9** Asthma (acute and maintenance rescue)
- J44.9** COPD (rescue)

ADULT DOSE

2-4 mg TDS (oral); 100-200 mcg MDI 1-2 puffs q4-6h (inhaled)

MECHANISM

Activates ;#"Ö G&VæW&v-2 &V6W F÷'2 " ' &öæ6†– Â 6Öö÷F, ðuscle relaxation

SIDE EFFECTS
Tremor, tachycardia, palpitations, hypokalemia (high dose)

CONTRAINDICATIONS
Severe cardiac arrhythmias

PREGNANCY
safe (category C; preferred in pregnancy asthma)

KEY INTERACTIONS
;"Ö lockers (antagonize), MAOIs, tricyclics

ALSO KNOWN AS
asthalin · ventolin · SABA · inhaler · asthma medicine · puff

Secnidazole

Secnil, Seczole, Entosec

5-nitroimidazole (antiprotozoal)

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: avoid 1st trimester

INDICATIONS

- A06.0 Amoebiasis
- A59.0 Trichomoniasis
- A04.7 Giardiasis

ADULT DOSE

2 g single dose

MECHANISM

Same as metronidazole; longer half-life allows single-dose therapy

SIDE EFFECTS

Metallic taste, nausea, headache

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Pregnancy 1st trimester, hypersensitivity to nitroimidazoles

PREGNANCY

avoid 1st trimester

KEY INTERACTIONS

Alcohol (disulfiram reaction), warfarin, lithium

ALSO KNOWN AS

secnil · secnidazole · antiprotozoal

Sertraline

Zoloft, Daxid, Sertima

SSRI antidepressant

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: paroxetine = avoid; sertraline is preferred (category C)

INDICATIONS

- F32.9 Major depression
- F41.1 Generalized anxiety
- F40.0 OCD
- F43.1 PTSD

ADULT DOSE

50-200 mg OD

MECHANISM

Selectively inhibits serotonin reuptake at presynaptic neuron

SIDE EFFECTS

Nausea, sexual dysfunction, insomnia, jitteriness (first 2 weeks), hyponatremia (elderly)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

MAOI use (14-day washout), pimozide

PREGNANCY

paroxetine = avoid; sertraline is preferred (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

MAOIs (serotonin syndrome), NSAIDs (bleeding), warfarin, tamoxifen

ALSO KNOWN AS

zoloft · daxid · SSRI · antidepressant · depression medicine

Sitagliptin

Januvia, Sitaglo, Istavel

DPP-4 inhibitor (gliptin)

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: avoid (limited data)

INDICATIONS

E11.9 Type 2 DM (add-on or monotherapy)

ADULT DOSE

100 mg OD

MECHANISM

Inhibits DPP-4 !' prolongs GLP-1 and GIP !' glucose-dependent insulin release

SIDE EFFECTS

Nasopharyngitis, headache, pancreatitis (rare), joint pain

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Type 1 DM, severe renal impairment (dose adjust), ketoacidosis

PREGNANCY

avoid (limited data)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Few; may enhance sulfonylurea-induced hypoglycemia

ALSO KNOWN AS

januvia · gliptin · DPP-4 inhibitor · diabetes medicine

Spironolactone

Aldactone, Spilactone, Spirono

Potassium-sparing diuretic (aldosterone antagonist)

Schedule H **Rx required** Pregnancy: avoid (category C)

INDICATIONS

- I50.9** Heart failure (with reduced EF)
- E26.0** Primary hyperaldosteronism
- L64.9** Androgenic alopecia (off-label)

ADULT DOSE

25-100 mg OD (25 mg for HF)

MECHANISM

Competitive aldosterone antagonist in distal tubule

SIDE EFFECTS

Hyperkalemia, gynecomastia, menstrual irregularities, impotence

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hyperkalemia, severe renal impairment, Addison disease

PREGNANCY

avoid (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

ACEi/ARBs (hyperkalemia), potassium supplements, NSAIDs

ALSO KNOWN AS

aldactone · MRA · potassium-sparing

Tamoxifen

Nolvadex, Tamodex, Valodex

Selective estrogen receptor modulator (SERM)

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: CONTRAINDICATED

INDICATIONS

- C50.9 Breast cancer (ER+)
- N97.0 Anovulation (off-label)

ADULT DOSE

20 mg OD

MECHANISM

Competitively blocks estrogen receptors in breast tissue

SIDE EFFECTS

Hot flashes, VTE risk, endometrial cancer (rare), visual changes, menstrual irregularities

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Pregnancy (teratogenic), history of VTE

PREGNANCY

CONTRAINDICATED

KEY INTERACTIONS

Warfarin, CYP2D6 inhibitors (reduce efficacy), rifampin

ALSO KNOWN AS

nolvadex · tamoxifen · SERM · breast cancer medicine

Telmisartan

Telma, Telpres, Telmikind

Angiotensin II receptor blocker (ARB)

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: CONTRAINDICATED (category D)

INDICATIONS

- I10 Hypertension
- I50.9 Heart failure
- E11.9 Diabetic nephropathy (T2DM)

ADULT DOSE

40-80 mg OD

MECHANISM

Selectively blocks AT1 receptor, preventing angiotensin II vasoconstriction

SIDE EFFECTS

Dizziness, hyperkalemia, hypotension, increased creatinine (usually transient)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Bilateral renal artery stenosis, pregnancy, hyperkalemia, severe hepatic impairment

PREGNANCY

CONTRAINDICATED (category D)

KEY INTERACTIONS

ACEi (avoid combo), potassium-sparing diuretics, NSAIDs (reduce effect), lithium

ALSO KNOWN AS

telma · ARB · BP medicine

Tiotropium

Spiriva, Tiova

Long-acting antimuscarinic (LAMA)

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: safe (category C)

INDICATIONS

- J44.9 COPD (maintenance)
- J45.9 Asthma (severe, add-on)

ADULT DOSE

18 mcg OD (HandiHaler) or 2.5 mcg/puff (Respimat) OD

MECHANISM

Long-acting M3 muscarinic receptor antagonist

SIDE EFFECTS

Dry mouth, urinary retention, constipation

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Hypersensitivity, narrow-angle glaucoma

PREGNANCY

safe (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

Anticholinergics

ALSO KNOWN AS

spiriva · tiova · LAMA · COPD medicine · inhaler

Tramadol

Ultram, Tramacip, Tramazac

Atypical opioid analgesic (μ-opioid receptor agonist)

Schedule H **Rx required** **Pregnancy: avoid (category C)**

INDICATIONS

- R52.1** Moderate-severe pain
- M25.5** Joint pain
- M79.1** Myalgia

ADULT DOSE

50-100 mg q6-8h (max 400 mg/day)

MECHANISM

Weak μ-opioid receptor agonist; also inhibits norepinephrine and serotonin reuptake

SIDE EFFECTS

Nausea, dizziness, constipation, seizures (high dose), serotonin syndrome with SSRIs

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Severe respiratory depression, MAOI use, opioid dependence, severe asthma

PREGNANCY

avoid (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS

SSRIs/SNRIs (serotonin syndrome), MAOIs, alcohol, sedatives, carbamazepine

ALSO KNOWN AS

tramacip · ultram · opioid · pain killer

Valproate

Valparin, Encorate, Valprol

Anticonvulsant (multi-mechanism)

Schedule H Rx required Pregnancy: CONTRAINDICATED for migraine; epilepsy = use lowest dose with informed consent (category D; N

INDICATIONS

- G40.9** Epilepsy (generalized)
- F31.9** Bipolar disorder
- G43.9** Migraine prophylaxis

ADULT DOSE

200-600 mg BD-TDS (up to 60 mg/kg/day)

MECHANISM

Blocks Na⁺ channels, increases GABA levels, T-type Ca²⁺ channel inhibition

SIDE EFFECTS

Weight gain, tremor, alopecia, hepatotoxicity, thrombocytopenia, hyperammonemia, teratogenicity (NTD)

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Liver disease, urea cycle disorders, pregnancy (migraine indication)

PREGNANCY

CONTRAINDICATED for migraine; epilepsy = use lowest dose with informed consent (category D; NTD, decreased IQ)

KEY INTERACTIONS

CYP inhibitor; increases levels of phenytoin, carbamazepine, lamotrigine, warfarin

ALSO KNOWN AS

valparin · encorate · valproate · anticonvulsant · epilepsy medicine

Vitamin D3 (Cholecalciferol)

D-Rise, Uprise-D3, Tayo-D3

Vitamin D supplement

Schedule OTC OTC Pregnancy: safe (category C)

INDICATIONS

- E55.9 Vitamin D deficiency
- M81.0 Osteoporosis (with calcium)

ADULT DOSE

1000-60000 IU weekly (loading); 1000-2000 IU daily (maintenance)

MECHANISM

Increases calcium and phosphate absorption; essential for bone health

SIDE EFFECTS
Hypercalcemia (very high dose), nephrocalcinosis

CONTRAINDICATIONS
Hypercalcemia, hypervitaminosis D, sarcoidosis

PREGNANCY
safe (category C)

KEY INTERACTIONS
Thiazides, anticonvulsants (reduce levels), cholestyramine

ALSO KNOWN AS
D-Rise · cholecalciferol · vitamin D · 60k

Warfarin

Warf, Acenocoumarol (Acitrom), Coumadin

Vitamin K antagonist (oral anticoagulant)

Schedule H

Rx required

Pregnancy: CONTRAINDICATED (teratogenic); use LMWH instead

INDICATIONS

I48.9	Atrial fibrillation
I26.9	PE/DVT (after heparin)
I21.9	Post-MI (with LV thrombus)

ADULT DOSE

2-10 mg OD (titrate to INR 2-3)

MECHANISM

Inhibits vitamin K epoxide reductase, reducing clotting factors II, VII, IX, X

SIDE EFFECTS

Bleeding, skin necrosis (rare, with protein C deficiency), purple toe syndrome

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Active bleeding, severe hepatic disease, pregnancy (1st trimester — teratogenic)

PREGNANCY

CONTRAINDICATED (teratogenic); use LMWH instead

KEY INTERACTIONS

MANY: aspirin, NSAIDs, antibiotics (esp. macrolides, metronidazole, TMP-SMX), amiodarone, CYP2C9 inducers/inhibitors, vitamin K-rich foods

ALSO KNOWN AS

warfarin · acenocoumarol · coumadin · blood thinner · anticoagulant